GreenSteps — Sustainability Research Brief (Sample Dataset)

Fictional report with numbers and cross-section facts for multi-hop RAG practice.

1. Project background

GreenSteps is a fictional mid-sized office that tracked electricity, commuting, and waste for the calendar years 2024 and 2025. The figures in this report are illustrative and should not be treated as real-world benchmarks.

2. Electricity

Electricity use was 120,000 kWh in 2024 and 102,000 kWh in 2025. The facilities team attributes the reduction to LED lighting, a revised cooling schedule, and shutting down unused meeting-room equipment. The project budget for lighting upgrades was ■4,80,000.

3. Commuting

In 2024, 40% of surveyed employees usually commuted by private car, 35% by public transport, 15% by two-wheeler, and 10% by walking or cycling. In the 2025 survey, the shares were 30%, 42%, 16%, and 12%, respectively. Survey participation was 200 employees in 2024 and 225 in 2025.

4. Waste

The office generated 18,000 kg of general and recyclable waste in 2024, of which 5,400 kg was documented as recycled. In 2025, total waste was 16,500 kg and documented recycled waste was 6,600 kg. The recycling contractor provides monthly weight tickets, which the sustainability team uses for verification.

5. Water

Measured water use fell from 2,400 cubic metres in 2024 to 2,160 cubic metres in 2025. The office installed low-flow taps in all 12 washrooms in March 2025. No separate measurement was available for rainwater harvesting, so the report does not estimate its contribution.

6. Employee engagement

GreenSteps ran four sustainability workshops in 2024 and six in 2025. Attendance rose from 86 total workshop attendances in 2024 to 148 in 2025. These are attendance counts, not unique participants, because an employee may attend more than one workshop.

7. Goals for 2026

The 2026 goals are to reduce electricity use by a further 8% relative to 2025, document at least 45% of total waste as recycled, and reach 55% public-transport commuting in the next employee survey. The report does not set a numerical water-use goal.

8. Measurement limitations

Electricity and water figures come from utility bills and meter records. Waste figures depend on contractor tickets and may exclude waste removed by tenants independently. Commuting data is self-reported and represents survey respondents rather than the entire workforce. Comparisons should acknowledge these limitations.

9. Responsibilities

Facilities owns electricity and water tracking. The sustainability team owns waste records and employee surveys. Finance verifies project spending. The operations director reviews progress every quarter.

10. Suggested follow-up

The report recommends maintaining monthly utility logs, recording recycling weights consistently, increasing public-transport incentives, and reporting survey participation alongside commuting percentages.